

Whatever doubts you've had about investing in the past, let them go. You are taking a new path here—one that is going to equip you with everything you need to be a successful investor.

Take Action

1. In a notebook or spreadsheet, create two columns. In the first, write down every fear or negative thought you have when it comes to investing. It can be based on your past experiences with investing if you've had any, or simply based on what you've heard from others or seen in the media. For example, one could be “I'm worried I'll lose my money in a recession.”
2. In the second column, write down all the things you wish you knew or would like to learn about investing that would help you counter each of the fears you've written down. Using our same example of a recession, the thing to learn could be “How to respond to a recession while investing.”
3. Keep this list handy as you go through this book. Check off the items you learn as you go along and cross out the fears next to them in the process. The more you know, the more confident you'll be as an investor and the fewer fears you'll have.

Clever girls know ... Investing is an essential part of being able to achieve the big financial goals you have for your life.

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WHY INVESTING MATTERS

In today's world, there are only two ways to make money.

The first way is the traditional one: working. We all know about this one. You receive income for performing a service and essentially trading your time for money. This method encompasses things like working for an employer part-time or full-time, working for yourself actively in your